RUM Community Group

2026-08-12 Edition

Agenda

- Keeping an Eye On:
  - Declarative Performance Observer
  - NavigationTiming landing attribute
- Barry's Bytes
- ABC revisit - Agentic Browsers

Logistics

- Meeting cadence
  - 2nd Wednesday of the Month
  - 60 minutes
  - 10am ET
- Agenda Document
  - (bit.ly/rumcg-agenda)
- Google Meet for Meetings
  - sub to rumcg-participants for invites
- Chat on Web Performance Slack
  `#w3c-rum-community-group`
  - (invites)
- public-rumcg@w3.org
  - (for discussions)
- RUM CG Github Repo
  - github.com/w3c-cg/rum
  - Group details
  - Links
  - Meeting minutes
- RUM CG Tracking Project
  - github.com/orgs/w3c-cg/projects/1
- Meeting Minutes via fireflies.ai
  - AI summary + transcript will be posted after
  - Full video recording also available

Next Meeting

- Wed **September 9th** @ 10am EST
  - 2nd **Wednesday** of each month
- Topics?
  - ?
- Submit & Vote topics @ bit.ly/rumcg-agenda

Topics Backlog

- ~~Better tracking/visibility into vendor positions (March 14)~~
- ~~Top tracking issues (e.g. this lighthouse issue) (March 14)~~
- ~~Baseline Project~~
- ~~Funding browser work for features~~
- ~~Header adoption (TAO, Server-timing)~~
- ~~Browser vendor presentations~~
- ~~RUM Archive~~
- ~~Callstacks from input delays (Issac Gerges thread in #general)~~
- ~~Container Timing awareness~~
- ~~ServerTiming / trailers~~
- ~~Bot and bad actor detection (bad CWV bots)~~
- ~~AI browsers~~
- ~~Open Telemetry~~
- Outreach to other groups (i.e. 3rd Parties, CDNs)
- Ad Blockers & tracking protection
- Implementation best practices
  - When to fire the beacon/how to deliver
  - SPA support
- Making sure we don't step on each other's toes (i.e. clearing RT buffers, multiple vendors on a page, etc.)
- Open source
- Securing the beacon

Keepin' an Eye On

Declarative Performance Observer

- https://github.com/explainers-by-googlers/declarative-performance-observer
- Presented to WebPerfWG June 18

Potential Solution

We propose a new declarative HTTP Response Header: `Performance-Observer`. This header integrates with the Reporting API.

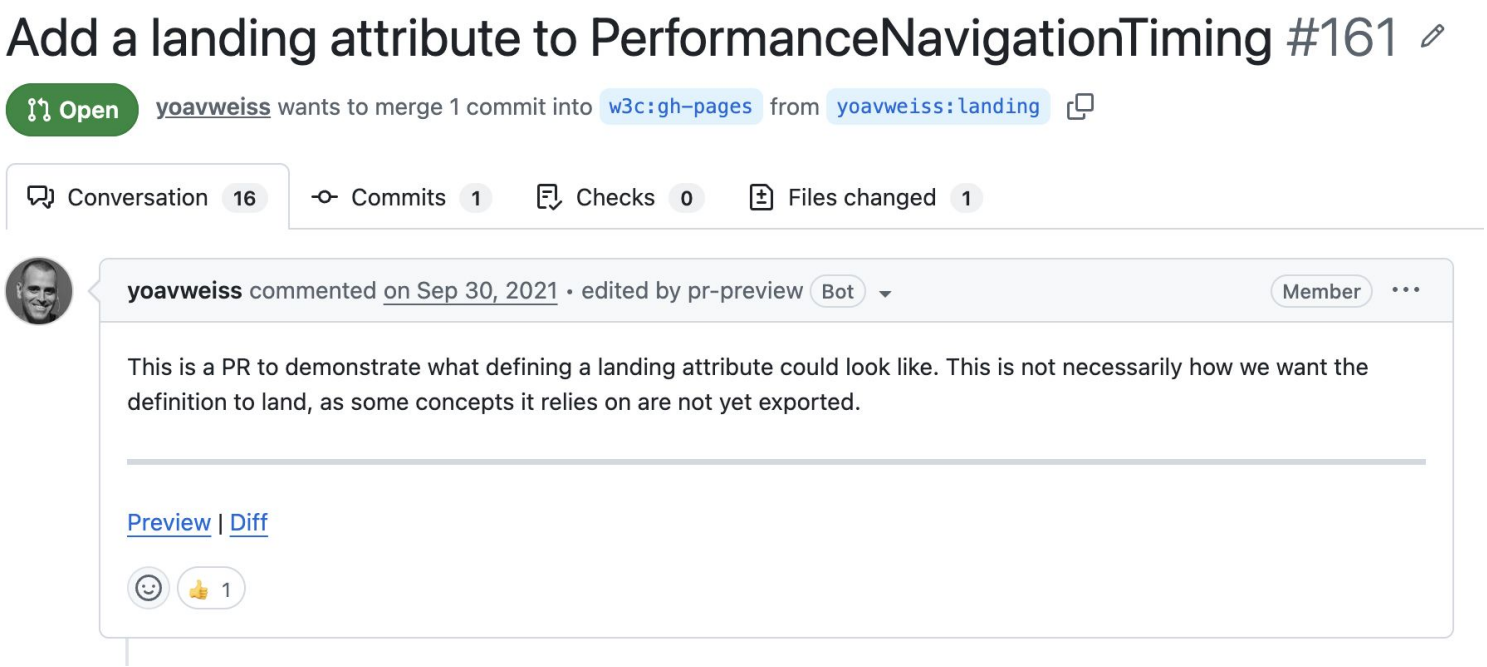
Syntax

```
Performance-Observer: report-to="telemetry", entry-types=("navigation" "mark" "visibility-state
Reporting-Endpoints: telemetry="https://log.com/v1"
```

- **report-to:** Routes the payload to the designated endpoint defined in `Reporting-Endpoints`.
- **entry-types:** Indicates which built-in performance events or visibility events should be recorded (e.g., "navigation", "mark", "visibility-state", matching PerformanceObserver.supportedEntryTypes).
- **include-user-timing:** Specifies an allowlist of user-defined `performance.mark()` or `performance.measure()` events to sync to the browser.
- **capture-early-failures:** A boolean directive. If enabled, the browser persists an origin-level flag to record future early navigation failures.

NavigationTiming landing attribute

- https://github.com/w3c/navigation-timing/pull/161




Google
BARRY'S
BYTES

Soft Navigations have landed!

Home > Articles

Was this helpful?

How SPA architectures affect Core Web Vitals

Answers to common questions about SPAs, Core Web Vitals, and how Core Web Vitals treats these.


Philip Walton

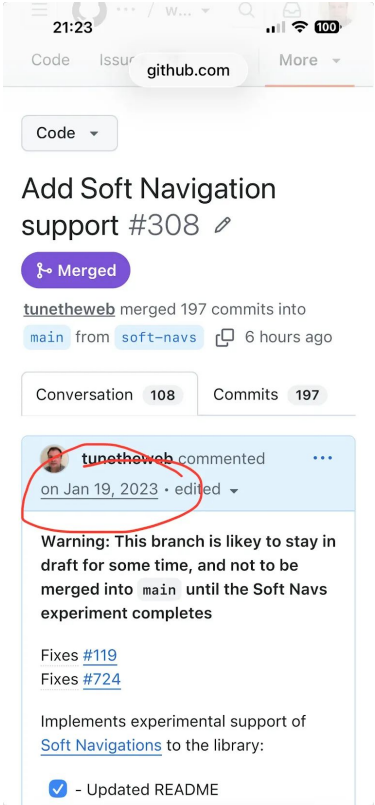

Yoav Weiss


Barry Pollard

Published: September 14, 2021, Last updated: August 11, 2026

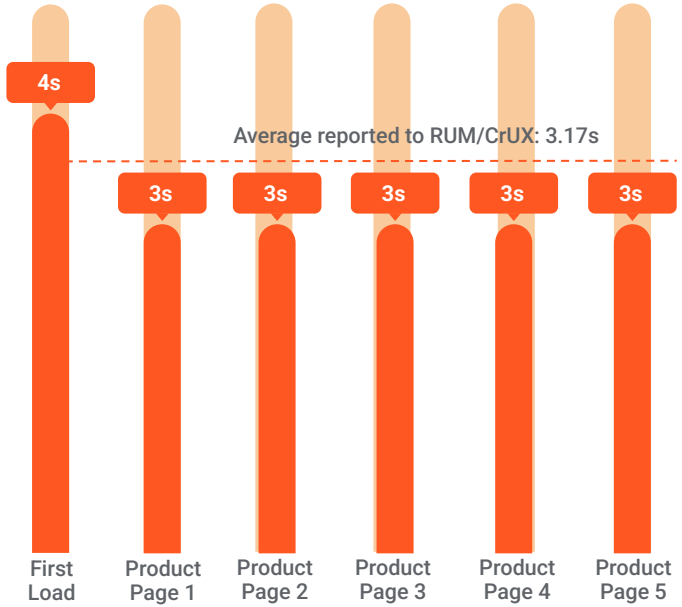
Update (August 2026): Chrome 151 released new APIs that allow measuring Core Web Vitals for SPA sites. See the Measuring soft navigations post for more details. This FAQ has been updated in light of these changes while retaining the historical context.

Since first introducing the Web Vitals initiative in May of 2020, we on the Chrome team have received a lot of great questions and feedback about the program.

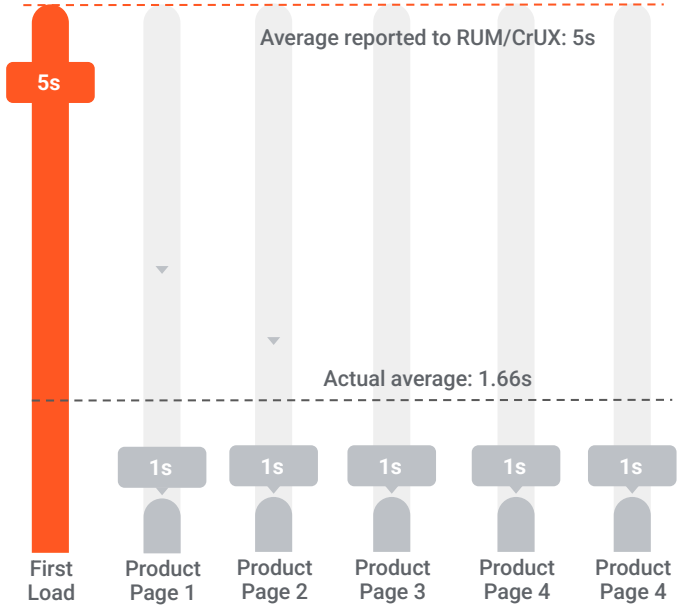


Soft Navigations - what was the issue again?

Traditional multi-page web site
The first load and follow up loads are counted.

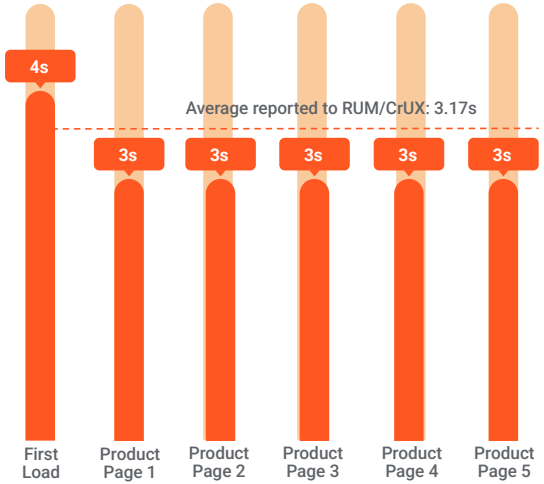


Single-page application
Only the first page load is reported to RUM and CrUX

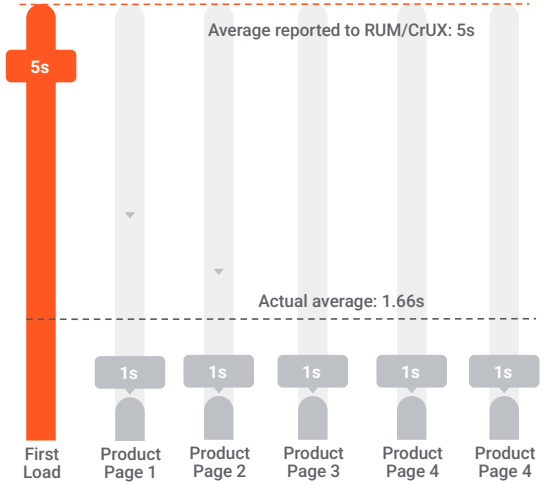


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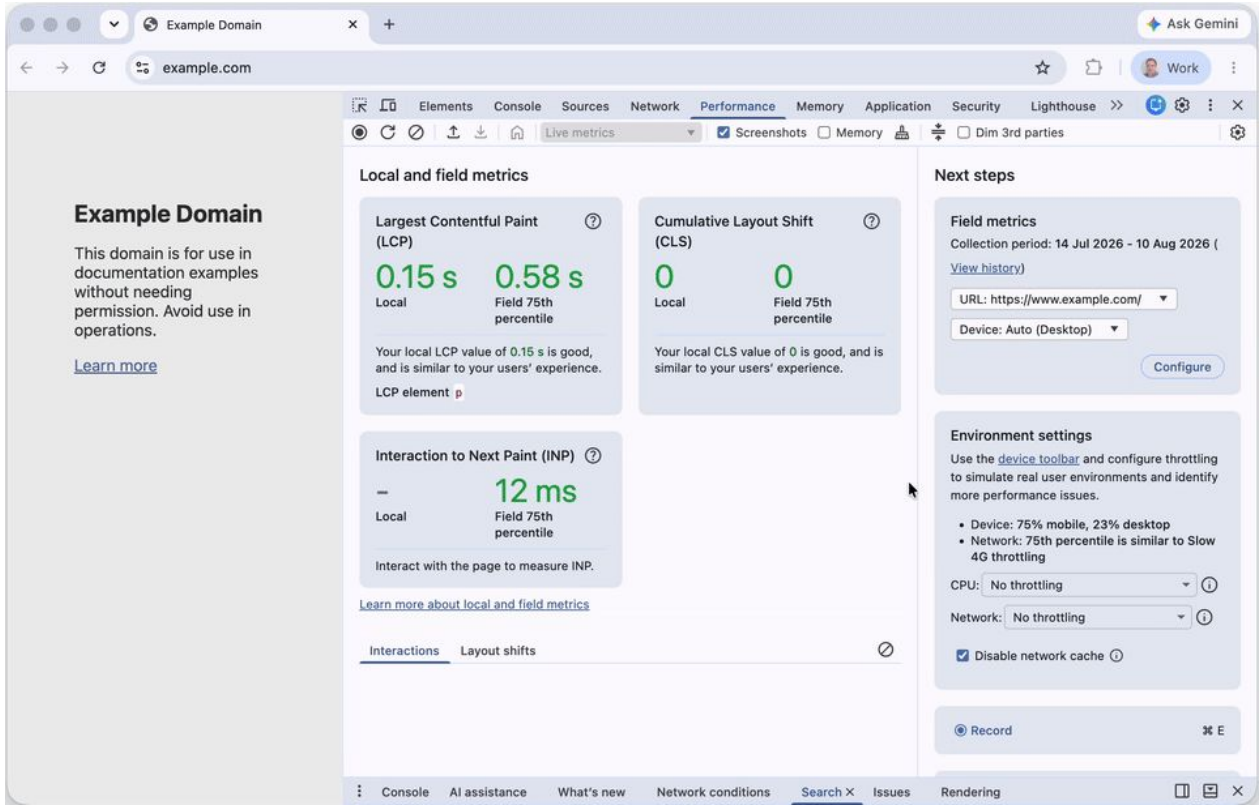
- Metrics are incomplete/wrong.
- Blind to soft navigation load time.
- Issues are attributed to the wrong page.

Soft Navigations - what is it?

- Two new performance APIs landed, unflagged, in Chrome 151 (stable July 28th):
  - `PerformanceSoftNavigation`
    - Triggers when a soft nav happens. Allows slicing CLS and INP.
  - `InteractionContentfulPaint`
    - Triggers when an interaction causes a paint. Allows measuring soft LCP.
  - MDN documentation in progesss (content#45053, compat data#30195).
- Web-vitals v6 includes support
  - Opt in! Not on by default.
  - Need to include URL when beaconing back metrics.
  - Does not include support for measuring yourself (though TTFB could be used for that).
- CrUX support is coming
  - No ETA... yet.
  - Experimental at first.

Soft Navigations - DevTools support

- **Chrome 144** added Nav* and LCP* markers to traces.
- **Chrome 152** adds support to Live Metrics (on by default).
- **Chrome 153** adds support to trace Insights (on by default).




There are a few provisos,
a couple of quid pro quos.

Soft Navigations - caveats

- Chromium only (including Edge, Opera, Vivaldi...etc.)
  - More on this later...
- The browser's definition of "soft navigation" may differ from yours. Or your frameworks.
- MPAs may have soft navigations
- Hard Navs metrics change
  - LCP does not change. But blended LCP changes the overall "score".
  - INP is only measured up until the first soft nav. Better attribution to the page that has INP issues.
  - CLS is only measured up until the first soft nav. Better attribution to the page that has CLS issues.
- Soft Navs are different
  - Content is already loaded. Resources are not requested.
  - Measures from click start (includes event handling).

What to do about non-supporting browsers?

Can fake it

- This has been tried before with limited success…
- LCP very difficult (impossible?) to measure this way.
- INP possible.
- CLS basically non-issue (Chromium only).

Can accept Chromium is now different

- Not ideal, but was the case for a long time (and still is for CLS).

Can ignore until better cross-browser compatibility

- Not recommended, valuable data in there now, you'd miss out on.
- No ETA on when/if this will happen.

Can measure both where supported

- Measure SPA for better attribution and to match CrUX.
- Measure non-SPA to understand differences between browsers.

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Try it!
If it's valuable, then let the other browsers know!

Soft Navigations - Questions and Feedback

- Are your customers asking for this?
- Are you planning on using this?
- If not, why not?
- What are you doing for the cross-browser story?
- What else can we (Chrome) do for this? In Chrome, in web-vitals, in Tooling, in docs, in specs?
- Any bugs/issues discovered?

Agentic Browser RUM

Agentic Browser RUM

- Slides @ https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1s9kuZMgddIvafvyRczdxmDvjDSwm3aqA74PuOCmB6dQ/